

Word family: **culture / cultures / cultural / culturally / cultured / multicultural / subculture / counterculture**

Base word: culture

Plural: cultures

Related forms: cultural, culturally, cultured

Useful lexical extensions: multicultural, subculture, counterculture

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / related adjective and adverb forms (相關形容詞及副詞)

Your sentence:

> “There are reading areas, reference sections, exhibitions, and sometimes public talks or **cultural** activities.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **cultural** means **related to arts, literature, history, ideas, traditions, or other activities through which people express and explore culture**.

In a library context, **cultural activities** could include:

- * exhibitions
- * talks
- * literary events
- * performances
- * heritage activities
- * arts-related events

**繁體中文： ** 文化的；與藝術、文學、歷史、傳統、思想或文化生活有關的 **

**中文翻譯： **

> “...public talks or **cultural activities**.”

「.....公開講座或**文化活動**。」

Here:

cultural activities = 與藝術、文學、歷史、傳統或文化交流有關的活動

1. **culture = shared way of life of a group (社會 / 群體) — 文化**

This is the broad central meaning.

****Meaning:**** The beliefs, customs, values, traditions, language, arts, behaviours, and ways of life shared by a society or group.

Practice 1

> “Food is an important part of ****culture****.”

「飲食是****文化****的重要一部分。」

Practice 2

> “Different ****cultures**** have different attitudes toward time.”

「不同****文化****對時間有不同看法。」

Practice 3

> “The book explores ancient Greek ****culture****.”

「這本書探討古希臘****文化****。」

****culture = 某個社會或群體共同形成並傳承的價值觀、習俗、信念、藝術、語言及生活方式****

Common:

- * local culture
- * traditional culture
- * popular culture
- * youth culture
- * cultural differences
- * cultural identity

This is the main social/anthropological sense.

2. ****culture = arts and intellectual life (藝術 / 文化生活) — 文化藝術 ; 人文活動****

****Culture**** can more narrowly mean the arts, literature, music, theatre, intellectual activities, and related creative life.

This branch is especially relevant to your passage.

Practice 4

> “The city invests heavily in arts and ****culture****.”

「這座城市在藝術與****文化****方面投入很多資源。」

Practice 5

> “Libraries play an important role in promoting ****culture****.”

「圖書館在推廣****文化藝術****方面扮演重要角色。」

****culture = 藝術、文學、音樂、戲劇、思想等人文和創意活動****

This is why we naturally say:

> cultural activities

> cultural events

> cultural institutions

For strict counting, this develops from Meaning 1, but it is prominent enough to display separately.

3. ****culture = norms and habits within an organization/group (組織) — 文化；風氣****

****Culture**** can describe the shared attitudes, expectations, habits, and ways of behaving within a company, school, team, profession, or organization.

Practice 6

> “The company has a very open ****culture****.”

「這家公司有一種非常開放的****企業文化****。」

Practice 7

> “The school is trying to build a stronger reading ****culture****.”

「學校正努力建立更濃厚的閱讀****風氣****。」

****culture = 某個組織或群體內逐漸形成的共同價值、習慣、行為方式和氣氛****

Common:

* company culture

* workplace culture

* school culture

- * safety culture
- * learning culture

This is a major modern extension.

4. **culture = a particular environment of attitudes/behaviour (風氣) — 風氣 ; 氛圍 ; 習性模式**

The word can extend beyond formal organizations to describe a wider pattern of behaviour.

Practice 8

> “The industry developed a **culture** of secrecy.”

「這個行業形成了一種保密的**風氣**。」

Practice 9

> “They want to create a **culture** of cooperation.”

「他們希望建立一種合作的**文化 / 風氣**。」

a culture of X = 一個群體中普遍存在、被強化或習慣化的某種行為 / 價值模式

For core counting, I would merge this with Meaning 3.

5. **culture = cultivation/growth of cells or microorganisms (生物 / 醫學) — 培養物 ; 培養**

This is a major scientific meaning.

A **culture** can be a population of bacteria, cells, fungi, tissue, etc. grown under controlled conditions for study or testing.

Practice 10

> “The laboratory grew a bacterial **culture**.”

「實驗室培養了一份細菌**培養物**。」

Practice 11

> “The sample was sent for **culture**.”

「樣本被送去做**培養檢驗**。」

****culture = 在控制條件下培養出來的細胞、微生物、組織等，或其培養過程****

Common:

- * bacterial culture
- * cell culture
- * tissue culture
- * blood culture
- * culture medium

This is genuinely distinct from social culture.

6. ****culture = verb: grow cells/microorganisms (動詞，科學) — 培養****

As a verb, ****culture**** means to grow cells, bacteria, tissue, etc. under controlled conditions.

Practice 12

> “The researchers ****cultured**** the cells in the laboratory.”

「研究人員在實驗室中****培養****這些細胞。」

Practice 13

> “The bacteria were ****cultured**** overnight.”

「這些細菌被****培養****了一晚。」

****culture something = 在適當條件下人工培養細胞、細菌、組織等****

This is the main modern verb sense.

7. ****culture = intellectual refinement / cultivated taste (修養) — 文化修養；教養****

In more formal English, ****culture**** can mean developed intellectual taste, education, or refinement.

Practice 14

> “He was a man of considerable ****culture****.”

「他是一位很有**文化修養 / 教養**的人。」

Practice 15

> “She valued education, literature, and **culture**.”

「她重視教育、文學和**文化修養**。」

culture = 透過教育、藝術、文學和知識培養出來的修養與鑑賞力

This sense is still valid, though less central in everyday conversation than the social meaning.

Related form: **cultural**

Cultural has several important uses.

**cultural = relating to a society's culture (文化的) **

Practice 16

> “There are major **cultural** differences between the two regions.”

「兩個地區之間存在明顯的**文化差異**。」

**cultural = relating to arts/intellectual activities (文化藝術的) **

This is your passage sense.

Practice 17

> “The library hosts many **cultural** events.”

「圖書館舉辦很多**文化活動**。」

Related form: **culturally**

Practice 18

> “The region is **culturally** diverse.”

「這個地區在**文化上**非常多元。」

Practice 19

> “The custom is **culturally** significant.”

「這個習俗在**文化層面上**具有重要意義。」

culturally = 在文化方面；從文化角度而言

Related form: **cultured**

Cultured has two particularly important branches.

cultured = refined/educated (有修養的) — 有文化修養的；有教養的

Practice 20

> “She is highly **cultured** and well read.”

「她很有**文化修養**，而且閱讀廣泛。」

cultured = 具有藝術、文學、知識方面修養和品味的

cultured = grown/produced under controlled conditions (培養的) — 人工培養的

Practice 21

> “The researchers studied **cultured** cells.”

「研究人員研究**培養的**細胞。」

Also:

> cultured pearls

= **養殖珍珠**

So **cultured** does not always mean “well educated.”

Context matters greatly.

Related form: **multicultural**

Multicultural means involving or containing several cultures.

Practice 22

> “The city is highly **multicultural**.”

「這座城市非常**多元文化**。」

multicultural = 由多種不同文化共同組成或涉及多種文化的

Related form: **subculture**

A **subculture** is a smaller cultural group within a larger society with its own distinctive values, style, practices, or identity.

Practice 23

> “The music developed within a youth **subculture**.”

「這種音樂是在一個青年**次文化**中發展起來的。」

Related form: **counterculture**

A **counterculture** is a cultural group or movement whose values deliberately oppose important norms of mainstream society.

Practice 24

> “The movement became part of the 1960s **counterculture**.”

「這場運動成為六十年代**反主流文化**的一部分。」

Important distinction: **culture vs society**

society

= the organized group of people and institutions

culture

= the beliefs, customs, values, practices, and expressive life associated with that group

So:

> society = 人群和社會結構

> culture = 這個群體形成的文化內容與生活方式

A society has a culture.

Important distinction: **culture vs tradition**

tradition

means a belief, custom, or practice passed down over time.

culture

is much broader and includes:

- * traditions
- * language
- * values
- * behaviour
- * art
- * beliefs
- * institutions

A tradition is one component of culture.

Important distinction: **culture vs custom**

custom

= one established social practice or habitual way of behaving

culture

= the broader system containing many customs and values

> greeting customs

> national culture

Important distinction: **culture vs civilization**

civilization

often emphasizes a large, complex historical society with institutions, technology, cities, etc.

culture

emphasizes shared beliefs, practices, arts, and ways of life.

A civilization may contain multiple cultures.

Important distinction: **culture vs heritage**

heritage

focuses on things inherited from the past:

- * traditions

- * monuments

- * language

- * history

culture

includes both inherited and constantly changing present-day practices.

Important distinction: **culture vs arts**

arts

specifically refers to creative activities such as:

- * music

- * theatre

* visual art

* literature

culture

is broader.

However, in phrases such as:

> arts and culture

culture often narrows toward public cultural/intellectual life.

Important distinction: **culture vs climate**

In organizations:

culture

= deeply rooted shared values, expectations, and habits

climate

= the current atmosphere or perception within the organization

For example:

> company culture

is usually deeper and longer-lasting than:

> workplace climate

Important distinction: **culture vs cultivation**

In biology/agriculture:

culture

often means growing cells, microorganisms, tissue, etc.

cultivation

more broadly means growing plants/crops or developing something carefully.

So:

> cell culture

> rice cultivation

Different typical domains.

Countability note

****Culture**** changes countability significantly.

Uncountable — general social concept

> “Culture changes over time.”

「文化會隨時間改變。」

Countable — particular cultural systems

> “The region contains many different cultures.”

「這個地區有很多不同文化。」

Countable — scientific specimen

> “The lab prepared three cultures.”

「實驗室準備了三份培養物。」

So context changes both meaning and grammar.

Useful expression: ****culture shock — 文化衝擊****

Practice 25

> “She experienced culture shock after moving abroad.”

「她移居海外後經歷了****文化衝擊****。」

****culture shock = 接觸陌生文化時因價值觀、習慣、語言或生活方式差異而感到的不適應或震撼****

This is a highly useful lexicalized compound.

Useful construction: ****a culture of X —的風氣****

Practice 26

> “The organization encourages a culture of openness.”

「這個組織鼓勵建立開放的****文化 / 風氣****。」

This belongs to the organizational-norm branch.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * ****culture****
- * ****cultures****
- * ****cultural****
- * ****culturally****
- * ****cultured****

Useful lexical extensions include:

- * ****multicultural****
- * ****subculture****
- * ****counterculture****

Also useful:

- * culture shock
- * company culture
- * popular culture
- * cell culture
- * bacterial culture
- * cultural activity

I would ****not**** mechanically fold words such as ****cultivate, cultivation, agriculture, horticulture**** into the immediate learner family. They are historically related but have sufficiently independent modern meanings to deserve separate entries.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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culture — shared way of life	某社會或群體共同形成的信念、價值、習俗、語言、藝術及生活方式
culture — arts/intellectual life	文學、藝術、音樂、思想等文化藝術及人文活動
culture — organization/group norms	組織或群體中共同形成的價值、習慣、行為方式及風氣
culture — biological noun	在控制條件下培養的細菌、細胞、組織等，或其培養過程
culture — biological verb	在實驗室等控制條件下培養細胞、細菌或組織
culture — refinement	因教育、藝術和知識而形成的文化修養與鑑賞力
cultural	與文化、藝術、人文活動、習俗或社會生活有關的
cultured — refined	有文化修養、有教養、有藝術品味的
cultured — biological/production	人工培養或養殖的
subculture	大社會內具有獨特價值和生活方式的次文化
counterculture	刻意反對主流社會價值的反主流文化

For your original sentence

> “There are reading areas, reference sections, exhibitions, and sometimes public talks or ****cultural activities****.”

The exact meaning is:

****cultural = 與藝術、文學、歷史、傳統、思想及文化交流有關的****

So:

> ****cultural activities****

= ****文化活動****

In this library context, it refers to activities that contribute to public intellectual and cultural life rather than merely practical library services.

For your database, I would count ****5 genuinely useful core meanings for `culture`****:

1. ****shared beliefs, customs, values, arts, and way of life of a society/group****
2. ****arts and intellectual/cultural life****
3. ****shared norms and behaviour within an organization/group****
4. ****biological culture — microorganisms/cells/tissue grown under controlled conditions****
5. ****intellectual refinement / cultivated taste****

The verb ****culture = grow cells/microorganisms**** should stay aligned with #4. I would merge ****culture of secrecy / company culture / safety culture**** into #3, and keep ****cultural / cultured / culturally / multicultural / subculture / counterculture**** as family extensions rather than inflate the base noun count.